FLEXquarters.com Limited

QODBC 2024

ODBC Driver for QuickBooks®

Quick Start Guide

designed for

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QODBC Driver License Agreement

Introduction

What is ODBC?

ODBC (Open Data Base Connectivity) is a specification designed by Microsoft to:

1. Allow Windows applications to access multiple data sources through a single method regardless of the underlying file formats;
2. Overcome the problem of different databases having different means of providing access to the information contained within them and;
3. Simplify access requirements so that the user does not need special skills to access databases.
4. In the same way that Windows has created an environment where all applications have a similar look and feel, ODBC drivers make all database formats look the same.

What is QODBC?

QODBC is an ODBC driver (DLL) for QuickBooks data. QuickBooks by default stores its data in its own proprietary database file format (.qbw). Our driver allows users of any application that can connect to ODBC data sources to read and write data contained in QuickBooks format files.

QODBC works by accepting SQL (Structured Query Language) commands through the ODBC interface, then converting those calls to navigational commands to the QuickBooks application interface (QuickBooks SDK) and returning record sets that qualify for the query results. QODBC will not work without an installed QuickBooks application and SDK layer to read the data from the proprietary internal database.

If you are not familiar with the SQL language, you can find a tutorial here:
http://www.w3schools.com/sql/default.asp

What can I do with QODBC?

QODBC opens your QuickBooks data to a whole new world of database connectivity.

- If you own Microsoft Office, you can use Excel to extract company accounting or invoice information directly into a spreadsheet and create a chart.
- Microsoft Word can run a customer mail merge for a customized batch letter directly from QuickBooks files.
- Crystal Pro Report writer can create multi-file reports from QuickBooks data.
- Microsoft Access or Embarcadero Delphi can be used to merge QuickBooks data with other data sources to produce complex reports, or to run mass file updates based on multiple criteria.

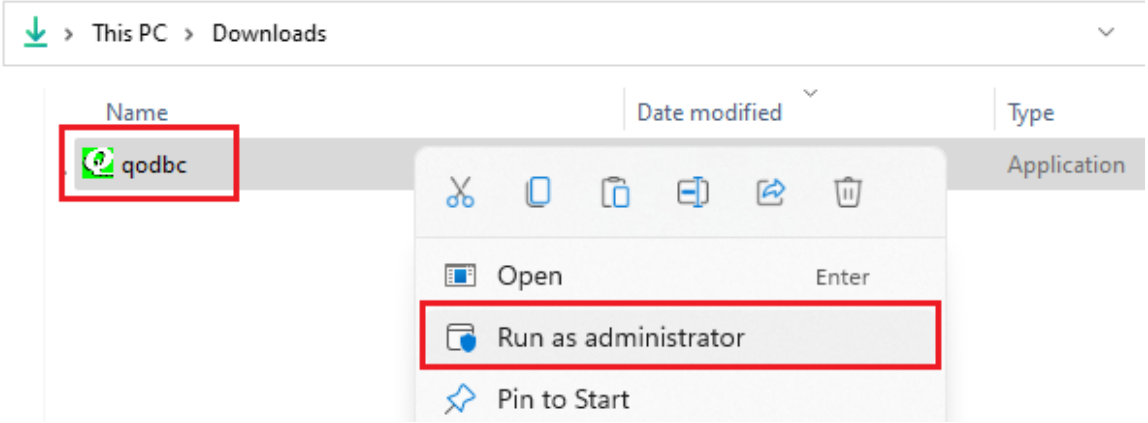
Best of all, this driver is transparent, invisible and works just like any other ODBC driver. QuickBooks application developers now can offer this driver to their customers to allow them direct access to data important to them through custom third-party applications. Business owners who require up-to-the-minute data to make informed business decisions can have that real-time data instantly available in any one of hundreds of desktop applications.

Installation

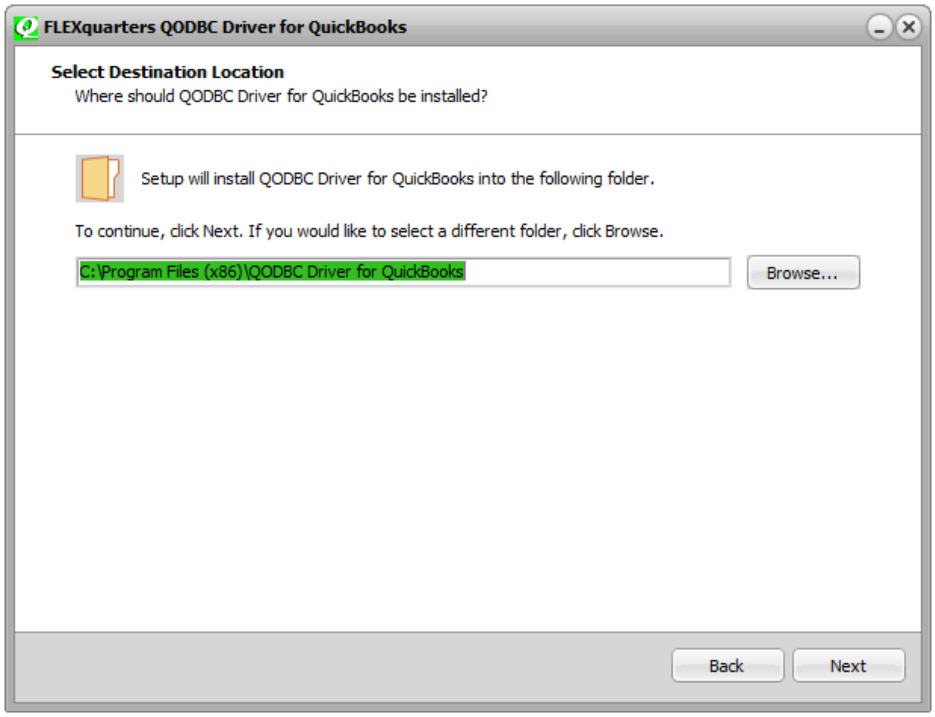
Initial Setup

First, make sure the **QuickBooks application is installed on the machine**. QODBC cannot access your QuickBooks company file data unless QuickBooks is installed on the machine. Click here to get the specifics on why the QuickBooks application is required.

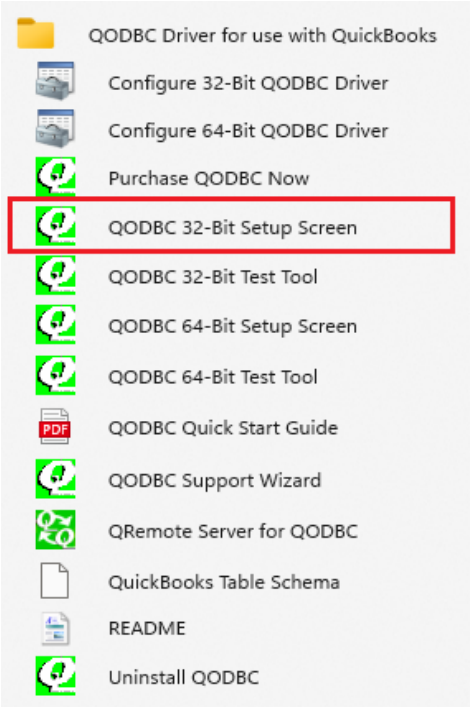
Right-Click on the Install program (qodbc.exe) and click “Run as Administrator” to install the driver. For more information or help regarding installation please click here.



You will be asked to select the destination directory to install the QODBC support files. You can skip the Activation Key if you want to evaluate the product before purchase. Click "Next" to continue.

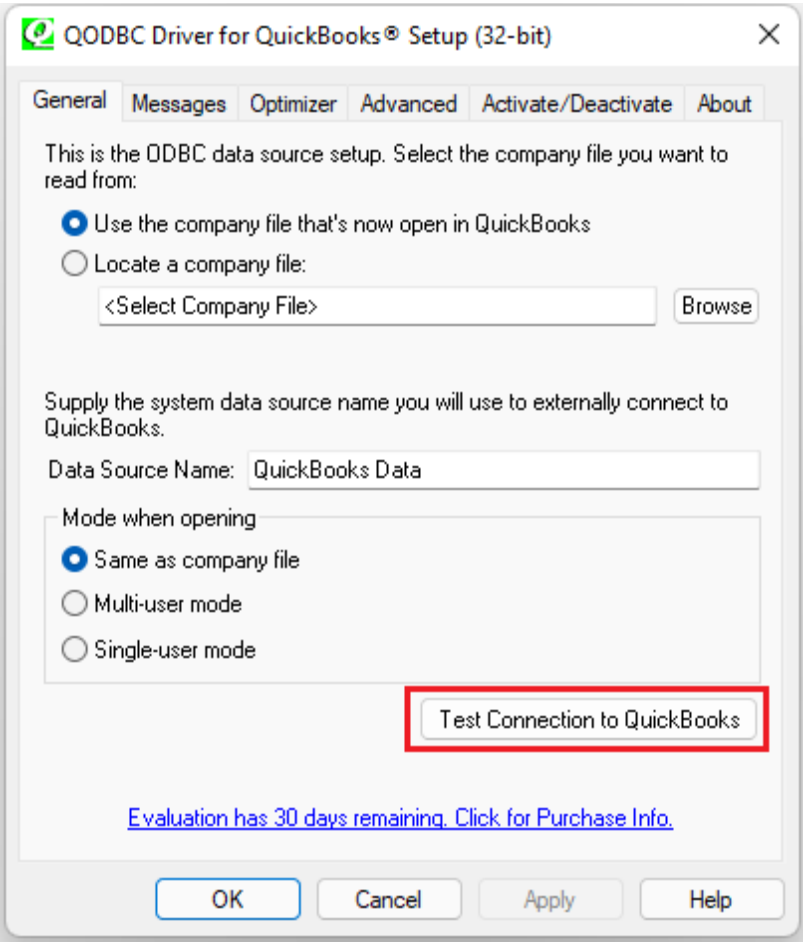


The FLEX*quarters* QODBC Driver for QuickBooks® has been successfully installed onto your computer. You can begin to use it immediately under the terms of the free 30-day evaluation. It will work with all editions of QODBC depending on how it is configured. Note that the evaluation version limits five (5) SQL statement execution per session and insert of records into QuickBooks to 20 per session.

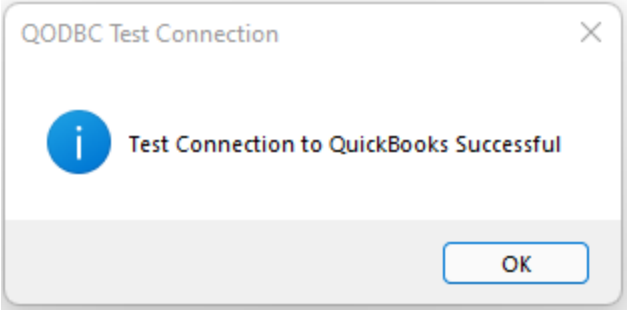


To upgrade QODBC from an evaluation copy to a full license registration code, see the icons that have been added to your Start Menu under QODBC Driver for QuickBooks®

The first step in configuring the driver is to click on the ODBC Setup Screen icon. The following screen will be displayed.



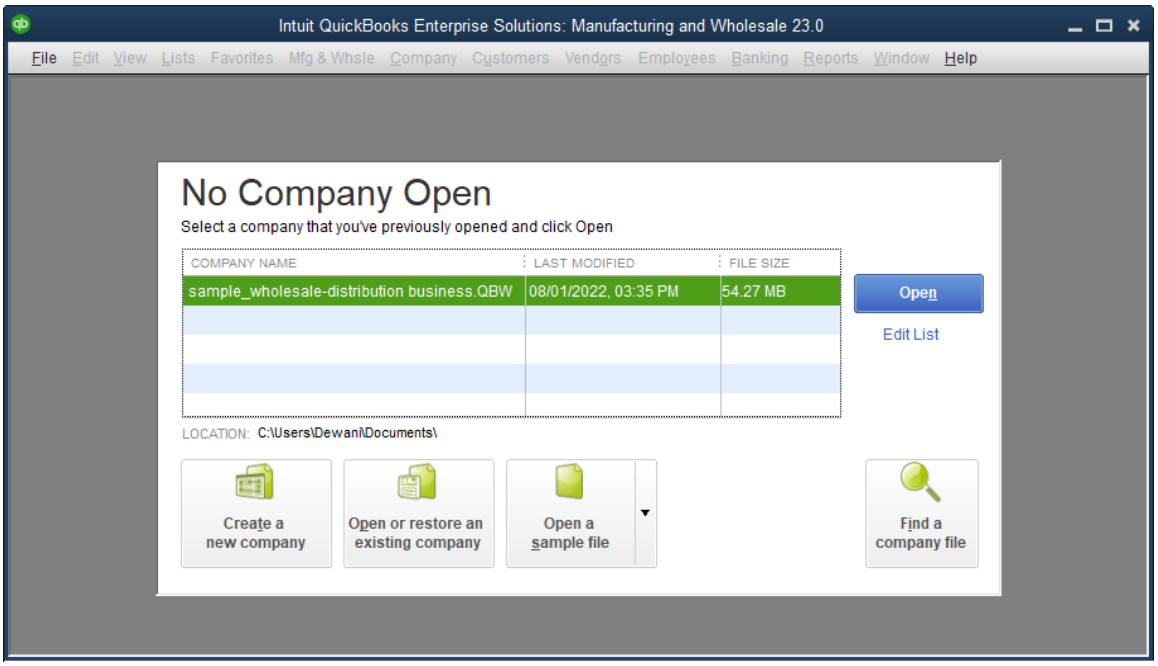
Click on the "Test Connection to QuickBooks" button to determine if you have a proper installation and settings with QuickBooks and a company file open. The following pop-up screen should appear:



Note: If you encounter a Windows security issue, or Test Connection fails, please click here.
See QODBC Setup Options for more details on options available.

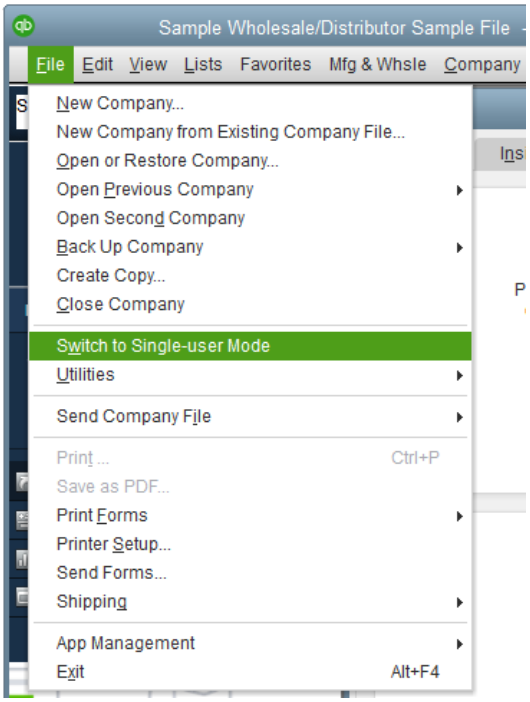
First use of QODBC after setup is complete

Start the QuickBooks Application. QODBC cannot access your QuickBooks data unless QuickBooks itself is running.

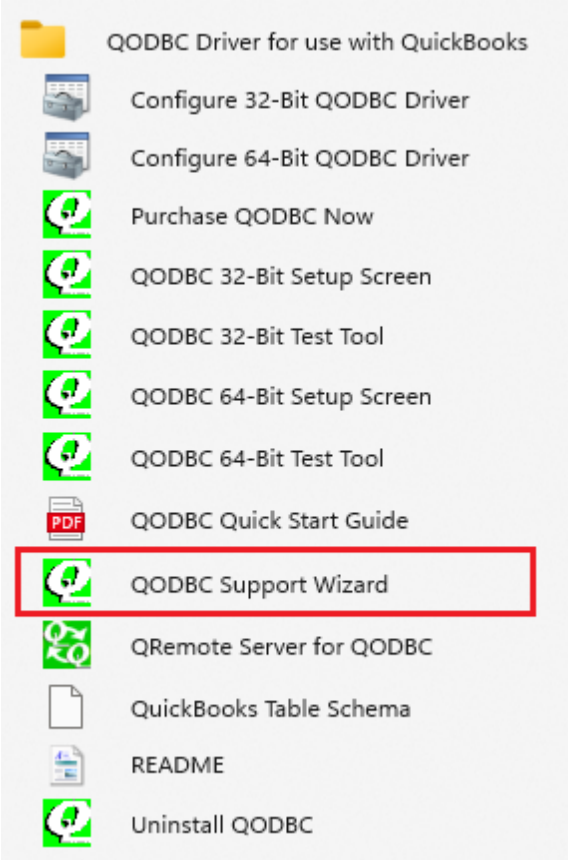


Note: QuickBooks application and QODBC Test tool should be launched normally. Do not start the application as "Run as Administrator".

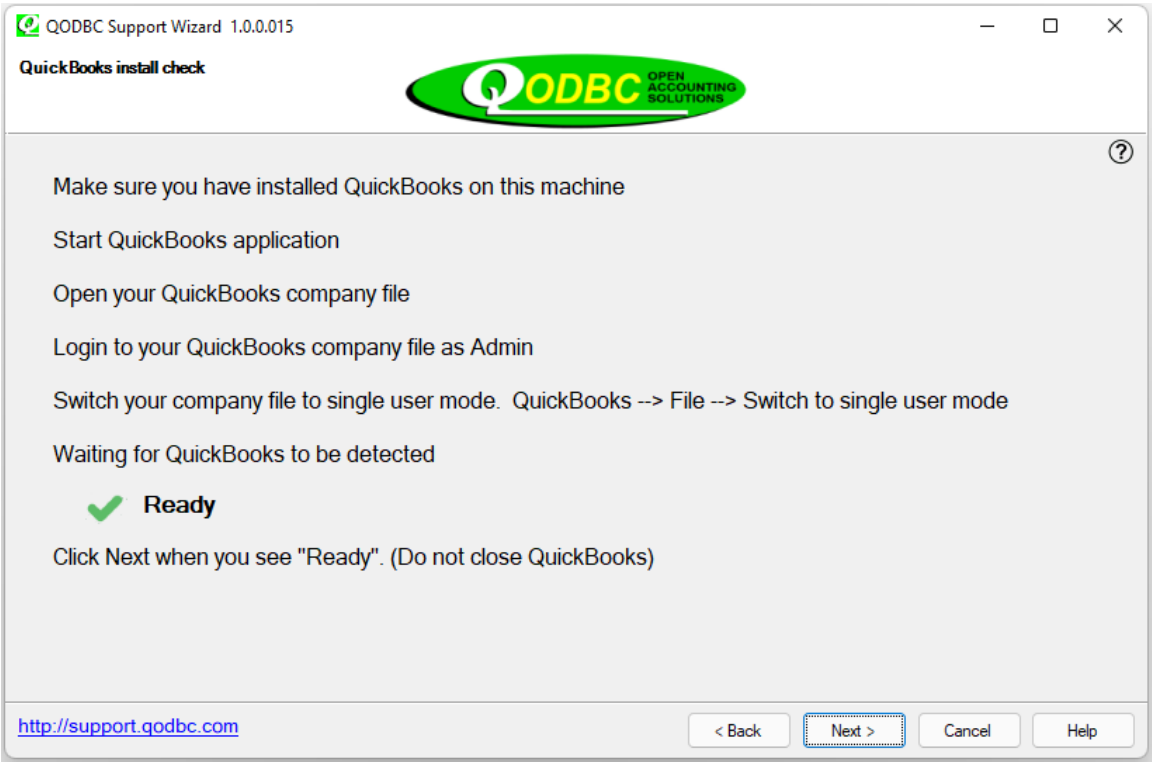
Login into your company file as “Admin” and Switch to Single-user Mode.



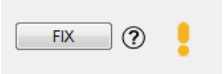
Click on the “QODBC Support Wizard” icon from the Windows start menu.



Follow the wizard instructions.



On the QODBC DSN Verification step, make sure it passes all the checks.

In case you see a warning icon 

. Please check the "FIX" button so the QODBC Support Wizard can automatically fix the issue.

Troubleshooting with QODBC Support Wizard

In case you are not able to connect to QuickBooks, re-run the Support Wizard and select “No, I am not able to connect to QuickBooks” and click “Next”

From the FAQs and Knowledgebase, you may select a more relevant topic or use the search button to search our knowledgebase for a more specific keyword.

If you are still facing an issue, report the issue to us by creating a support ticket. **Free Support System** registration and support ticket submission at http://support.qodbc.com.

QODBC Frequently Asked Questions

The Frequently asked questions about this product are constantly changing, so we have a web page setup with these questions and answers. A more detailed FAQ can be found at: http://support.qodbc.com.

Tutorials and Documentation

Additional information can be found on our web site, including a full manual, step-by-step tutorials for popular applications, FAQs, data layout of QuickBooks and video tutorials.

Documentation:

- Data Layouts (Schema)
- FAQ
- QODBC Manual & QODBC White Papers

Step by Step Tutorials qodbc.com/tutorials

- Connecting to QuickBooks the First Time
- 64 Bit Applications
- Microsoft Access
- Microsoft Visual Basic and ADO
- Microsoft Excel
- Microsoft Word
- Microsoft Office
- Crystal Reports
- Alpha Five
- Microsoft SQL Server
- Web Edition/Cold Fusion
- Web Edition/PHP
- Create Sales Receipts

- Create Invoices
- Purchase Orders
- Create Bills
- Deposits
- Inventory Adjustments
- How to setup QODBC to run without QuickBooks
- How to setup QODBC Driver to auto-connect to QuickBooks. (Video)
- How to setup QODBC for Auto-login into QuickBooks

Windows Support

QODBC version 2024 supports Microsoft Windows XP, Windows Vista, Windows 7, Windows 8, Windows 8.1, Windows 10 and Windows 11.

Product Support

We offer a free fully functional 30-daytrial copy of QODBC. A FAQ section and a Help Desk support system is available for registered users and those evaluating QODBC. Those purchasing the product will receive installation support at no charge for 30 days from the date of purchase. Program anomalies will be addressed at no charge and updaters posted on our web site. Other issues may be subject to a fee.

Support can be obtained by the following methods:

Forum Online Support: http://support.qodbc.com
E-mail: support@qodbc.com
Mail: FLEXquarters USA Sales
P.O. Box 1466, Clarkston, MI 48347

The most effective of these methods is the online support system via our website, since you can attach an ODBC or SDK trace log to the message, and we can attach an updated product to you if we have a patch.

Product Updates

The latest updated versions will always be available onlineat our web page:qodbc.com/download/desktop

QODBC Credits

QODBC versions 2.x thru 24.x
For Microsoft Windows, Windows XP, Vista, Windows 7, Windows 8, Windows 10 and Windows 11.

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Version 2.0 First released October 2002
Version 3.0 First released January 2003
Version 4.0 First released November 2003
Version 5.0 First released October 2004
Version 6.0 First released November 2005
Version 7.0 First released October 2006
Version 8.0 First released September 2007
Version 9.0 First released October 2008
Version 10.0 First released September 2009
Version 11.0 First released October 2010
Version 12.0 First released October 2011
Version 13.0 First released September 2012
Version 14.0 First released September 2013
Version 15.0 First released September 2014
Version 16.0 First released September 2015
Version 17.0 First released September 2016
Version 18.0 First released September 2017
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